influence in these areas requires robust economic development and new security capabilities supported by the U.S. and others.

However, the new government is also pursuing problematic new so-called peace agreements with local militants along the Afghan border. The CIA Director just a month ago said that the situation on the Pakistan-Afghanistan border ''presents a clear and present danger to Afghanistan, to Pakistan, and to the West in general,'' as well as to ''the United States in particular.''

I look forward to hearing the comments from the witnesses. And in conclusion, let me just reiterate that it remains in our nation's long-term interest to forge an enduring strategic partnership with a democratic, stable, and prosperous Pakistan that remains a strong partner in the campaign against Islamic militants and which maintains responsible controls over its nuclear weapons technology. We look forward to working with the Pakistani Government and the Pakistani people to accomplish this worthy goal.

And I yield back the balance of my time. Thank you, Mr. Chairman.

Chairman Berman. The time of the gentlelady has expired. And I am pleased to recognize the chairman of the Middle East and South Asia Subcommittee, the gentleman from New York, Mr. Ackerman, for 3 minutes.

Mr. Ackerman. Thank you, Mr. Chairman. ''The United States has not met its national security goals to destroy the terrorist threat and close the safe haven in Pakistan's FATA region.'' With that quote, the Government Accountability Office has clearly and succinctly described what is wrong with United States policy toward Pakistan: It has failed. GAO goes on to note that since 2003, the administration and Congress have recognized that all elements of national power needed to be brought together to deal with terrorist threats emanating from the Federally Administered Tribal Areas. Yet despite demands from Congress, there remains no integrated strategy and our Embassy in Islamabad has had to cobble one together for itself without support from Washington.

But we were able to send the Government of Pakistan $10 billion. Ten billion dollars, and we have not met our national security goals. Yet the Bush administration is not actually seeking a new strategy. In fact, it seems they would like to double down on the guy who got them this far. But the inconvenient truth, if I can borrow a phrase, is that elections have produced a new government that ran against the administration's man and implicitly against his relationship with the United States.

We need a new plan. The new plan needs to build a relationship with Pakistani institutions, not just one Pakistani individual. It needs to help Pakistanis build on the foundations of moderate Islam, devotion to democracy and justice, and a vibrant civil society. The United States needs to have many friends in Pakistan, not just one. But our friends in Pakistan must come to recognize that the terrorists who inhabit their borders are an existential threat to them. The Pakistani people, and not just government ministers, must see the fight against terrorism as more than simply yet another war the Americans want them to fight.

I understand the new government's desire to distance itself from President Musharraf's policies and, by extension, to distance itself from us. But I also remain deeply concerned that the policy of negotiating with terrorists is one that has failed in the past and will likely fail again. Perhaps this is the course of democracy in Pakistan, that the path of negotiations must be tried once more before a democratically elected government can apply more forceful measures.

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